

Feature Engineering Report

This report documents the feature engineering workflow. The daily Baltic Dry Index series was aggregated to monthly mean, standard deviation, range, and return values before joining with monthly Brent prices, Botswana policy rates, and FAO consumer price indices. The target is FAO Item 23014 food price inflation, and lag features were built from the inflation series only so that no future information is leaked into the training window. Unavailable 2024 features were handled by relying on the latest available monthly values and by keeping the modelling window consistent with the available historical data.